

innovative investors keep following this logic, they will realize that this links every single block in Bitcoin's blockchain together. As a result, no information in any past block, even if it was created years ago, can be changed without changing all of the blocks after it. Such a change would be rejected by the distributed set of miners, and this property is what makes Bitcoin's blockchain and the transactions therein immutable.

Miners are economically rewarded for creating a new block with a transaction that grants them newly minted bitcoin, called a coinbase transaction, as well as fees for each transaction. The coinbase transaction is also what slowly releases new bitcoin into the money supply, but more on that later.

A USEFUL ANALOGY FOR BITCOIN'S ECOSYSTEM

To tie everything together using an analogy that will prepare us for a discussion of the applications of blockchain technology in [Chapter 3](#) (see [Figure 2.1](#)). It's helpful to think of the concepts as a stack of hardware, software, applications, and users in relation to a personal computer.